



U.S. ARMY

Concrete Experience



YOU CAN'T PARK THERE



United States Army Cyber Center of Excellence

Electromagnetic Warfare PLT Movement Techniques

112-17ABOLC

OVERALL CLASSIFICATION:

UNCLASSIFIED



Learning Step Activities



U.S. ARMY

- LSA 1 - Examine Combat Power of the EW PLT by Mobility Type
- LSA 2 - Discuss Key Considerations of Mobility Type
- LSA 3 - Analyze Formations and Techniques by Mobility Type
- LSA 4 - Examine Actions on Contact



Administrative Information



U.S. ARMY

Safety Requirements NONE

Risk Assessment Level LOW

Environmental Considerations None

Evaluation None



References

U.S. ARMY

- FM 3-12. *Cyberspace and Electromagnetic Warfare Operations*. 17 Sep 2025.
- FM 3-90. *Tactics*. 10 May 2023.
- ATP 3-12.3, C1. *Electromagnetic Warfare Techniques*. 18 Sep 2024.
- ATP 3-12.4. *Electromagnetic Warfare Platoon*. 09 Jan 2023.
- ATP 3-21.8, C1. *Infantry Rifle Platoon and Squad*. 23 Jun 2025.



U.S. ARMY



Examine Combat Power of the EW PLT by Mobility Type



Examine the EW PLT

U.S. ARMY

- PE: Break into 3-5 groups and take 20 minutes to examine the combat power of an average Rifle PLT and an EW PLT, both within an MBCT and an ABCT:
 - What are the main differences?
 - Did you find anything surprising?
 - What affects does this have on an EW PLTs ability to conduct fire and maneuver?
 - What about leadership and command and control?
 - How large of a formation can each PLT fight against?
 - How much security can each PLT provide?

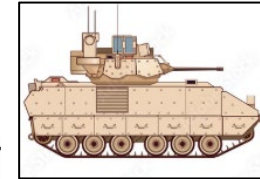


EW PLT (HHC-ABCT) vs Rifle PLT (IN CO-ABCT)

Mounted Combat Power Comparison



U.S. ARMY



VS



Dismounts



Ø x6





Examine the PLT Dismounted



U.S. ARMY

- Doctrine states that a 3:1 advantage is generally required to successfully maneuver against and destroy an enemy force.
- EW PLTs prioritize security and stealth when moving dismounted while avoiding and engaging the enemy whenever possible.





Examine the Rifle PLT Dismounted (MBCT)



U.S. ARMY

- Rifle PLT: Designed to close with and destroy the enemy.
- A Rifle PLT can maneuver against a 12-man enemy unit.
- M240's provide stand off and additional fire power to combat enemies in cover.
- Rifle PLTs act as a PLT when conducting operations.





Examine the EW PLT Dismounted (MBCT)



U.S. ARMY

- EW PLT: Not designed to close with and destroy the enemy.
- An MFRC EW PLT can maneuver against a 10 man enemy unit.
 - An EW Team can maneuver against 1-2 man enemy unit.
- M249s provide more suppression than M4s but not much ability to combat enemies in cover.
- EW PLT is commonly separated into the Squads then maneuver as teams separately.





Examine the PLTs Mounted (ABCT)



U.S. ARMY

- Rifle PLT: Designed to rapidly close with the enemy and deploy dismounts.
 - Flexibility and maneuverability.
 - M242 Bushmaster 25mm chain guns to suppress the enemy.
 - Can provide own security through dismounts.
- EW PLT: Not designed to fight mounted.
 - Only 3 of 4 VICs have mountable weapon systems.
 - Largest Caliber is 5.56mm.
 - Limited survivability against other vehicles or anti-tank weapons.



U.S. ARMY



Discuss Key Considerations of Mobility Type



M2A3 Infantry Fighting Vehicle (BFV)



U.S. ARMY

- Tracked, heavily armed armored vehicle used to transport infantry, conduct reconnaissance, and provide direct fire support.
- Key Capabilities & Specifications
 - Capacity:
 - 3 Crew
 - 6 Infantry Dismounts
 - Armament:
 - 25mm M242 Bushmaster chain gun
 - 7.62mm M240C machine gun
 - 2x BGM-71 TOW anti-tank missile launchers





M2A3 Infantry Fighting Vehicle (BFV)



U.S. ARMY

- Armor: Composite armor designed to protect against small arms fire and artillery fragments
- Mobility: 500-horsepower engine, reaching top speeds of 34-37 mph
- Key Details
 - Purpose: Developed to operate alongside the M1 Abrams tank, offering superior protection and firepower compared to the older M113 personnel carrier
 - Combat Roles: Used for scouting, troop transport, and destroying enemy armored vehicles.



EW PLT Operations

U.S. ARMY

- How EW operations happens depends on:
 - Mission
 - Commanders' philosophy
 - SOPs
- Two general methodologies of operations for an EW PLT:
 - Centralized:
 - PLT is left a whole unit operating under direct control of the EW PL.
 - Decentralized:
 - EW PLT is parceled out in team/squad sized elements as TACON to maneuver elements.
 - EW PL retains ADCON or OPCON of PLT depending on the situation.



EW PLT Operations

U.S. ARMY

- End state:
 - The base line dismounted element for the PLT that should be trained the most is the EW team.
 - Build and refine cohesive teams with well-established SOPs.
 - Train teams on how to maneuver securely and stealthily.
 - Train on Mounted PLT formations during collective training.





U.S. ARMY



Analyze Formations and Techniques by Mobility Type



Identify Dismounted Formations



U.S. ARMY

- 3 basic echelons to a PLT.
 - PLT: 14-30 man element led by a LT.
 - Squad: 9-man element led by a SSG.
 - Team: 4-man element led by a SGT.
- Any combination of the 3 formations can be used to maximize a PLT's ability to shoot, move and communicate given METT-TC(I).

Example: PLT Column, Squad Column, Team Wedge





Identify Dismounted Formations

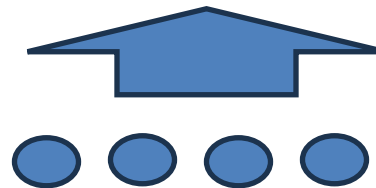


U.S. ARMY

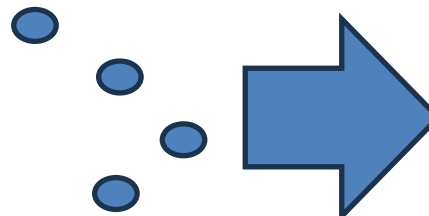
- 7 basic types of formations for a dismounted element.
- 3 most common:
 - Column (File): Prioritizes speed and control and the cost of fire power



- Line: Prioritizes fire power to the front and control at the cost of speed



- Wedge: Prioritizes 360 security/flexibility ant the cost of speed





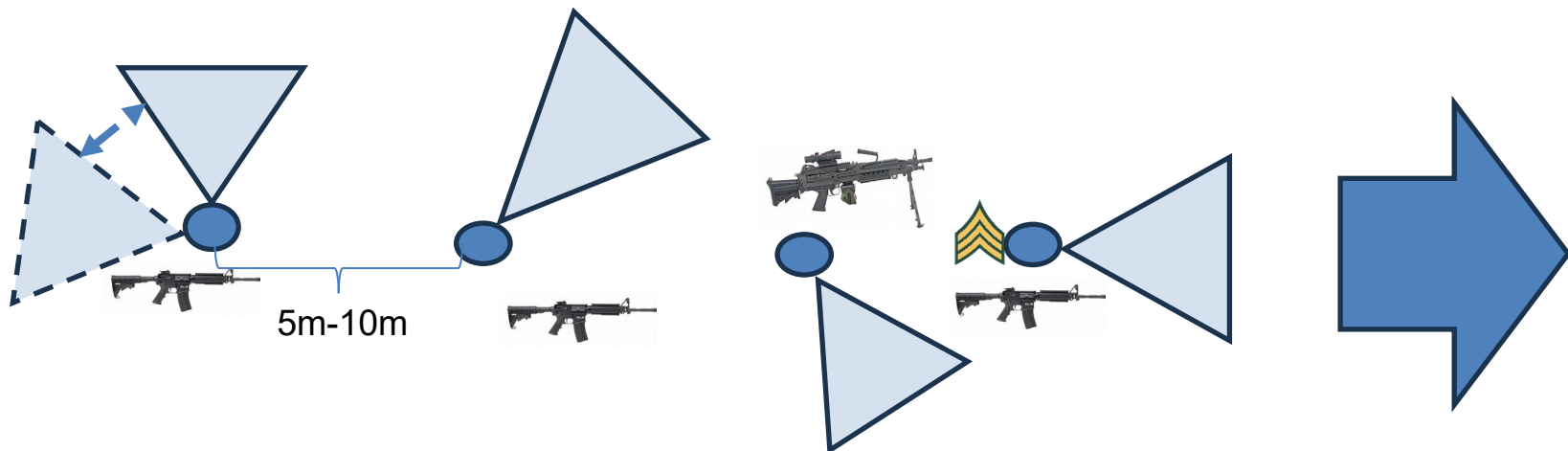
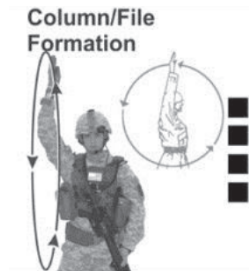
Maneuvering as a Dismounted Team - Column



U.S. ARMY

- Fire team Column (File):
 - Team Leader up front
 - M249 Behind TL for control
 - 2x M4s in trail
 - Used for quick/short movements or when terrain is severely restricted

Hand and Arm signal: Doctrine



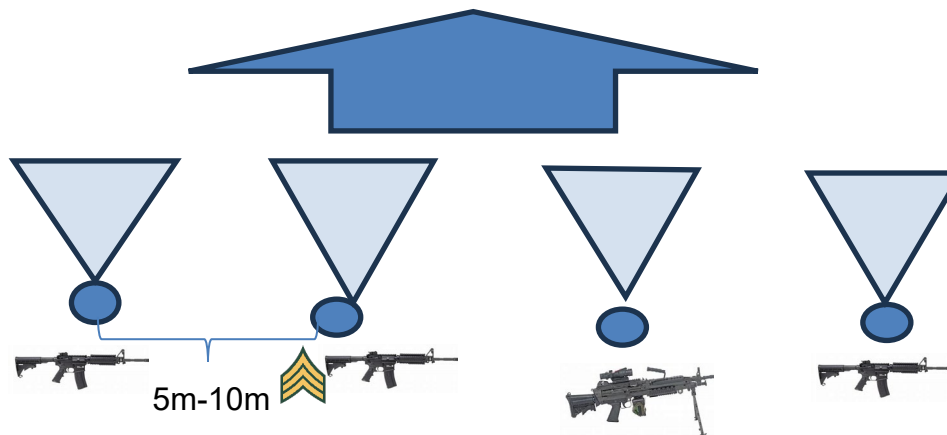


Maneuvering as a Dismounted Team - Line



U.S. ARMY

- Fire team Line:
 - Team Leader in the middle
 - M249 Leaders' discretion
 - 2x M4s leaders' discretion
 - Used for deliberately clearing through terrain, a base of fire or when contact is extremely likely from one direction.





Maneuvering as a Dismounted Team - Wedge



U.S. ARMY

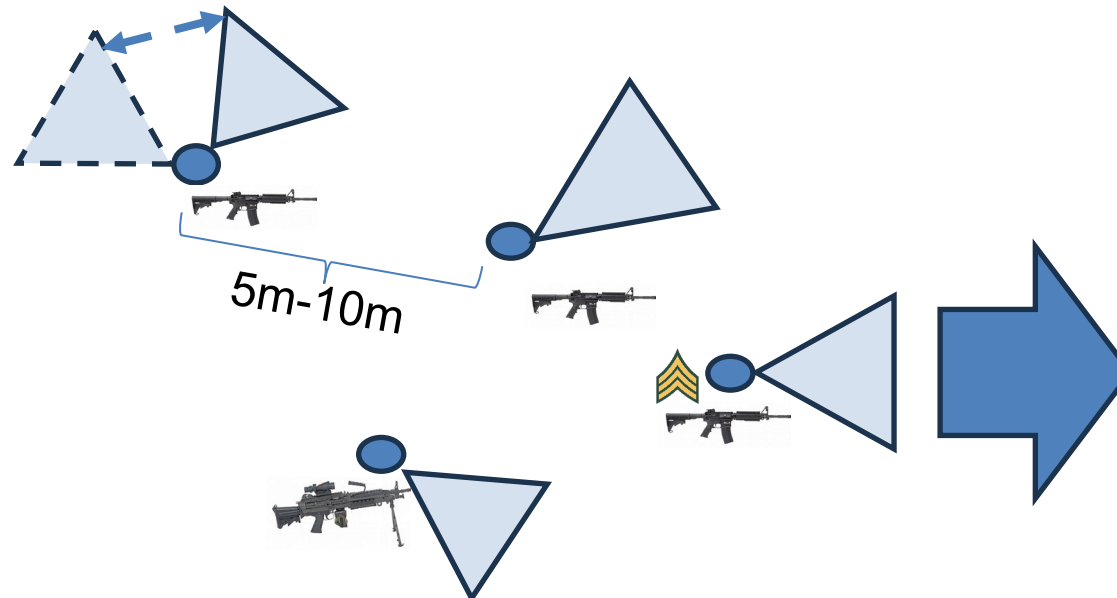
- Fire team Wedge:
 - Team Leader up front
 - 2x M4s on one side (Strong side)
 - 1x M249 (Weak side)
- Used as the default when moving

Hand and Arm signal:

Reality



Doctrine



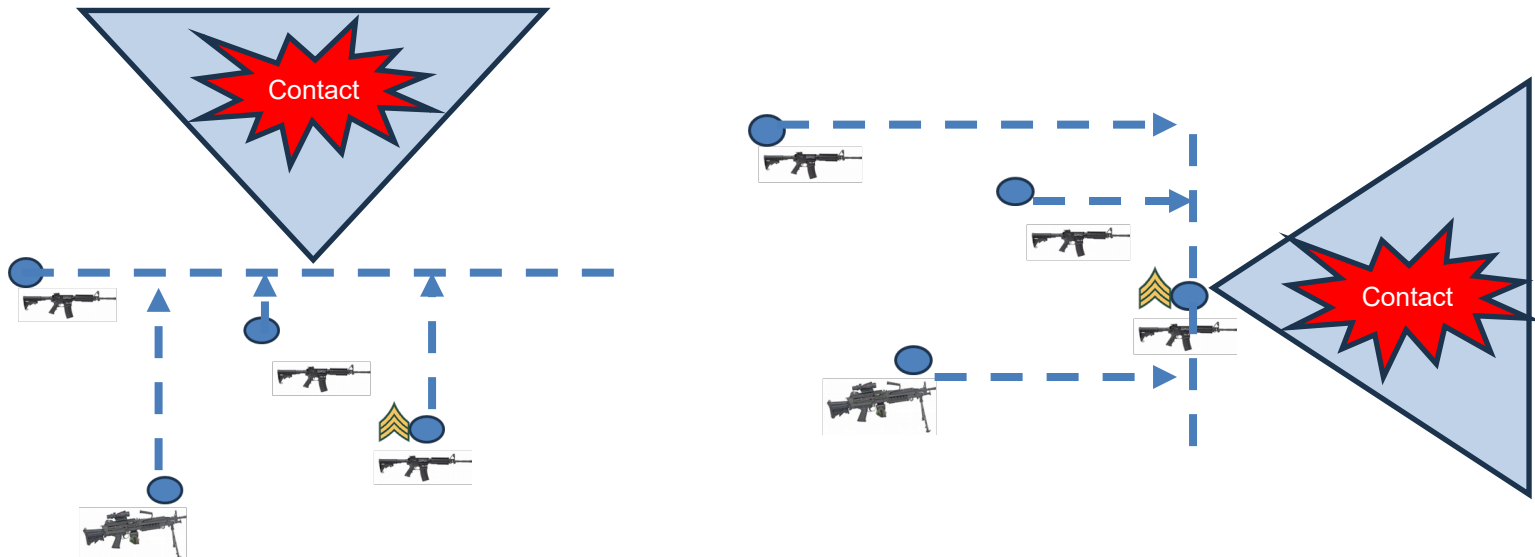


Maneuvering as a Dismounted Team - Wedge



U.S. ARMY

- Wedge in action:
 - The wedge is the most versatile formation
 - It allows the element to easily transform into a base of fire in any direction
 - Training, Rehearsing, and SOPs make these transition faster!





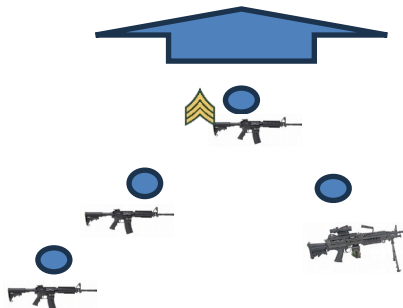
Maneuvering as a Dismounted Team – Movement Techniques



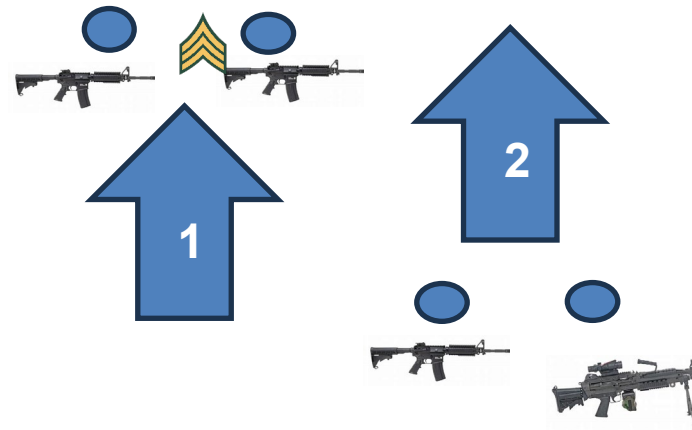
U.S. ARMY

- Movement Techniques:
 - Traveling - Used when speed is necessary and contact with enemy forces is not likely.
 - Traveling Overwatch - Used when contact with enemy forces is possible.
 - Bounding Overwatch - Used when contact with enemy forces is expected.

Traveling: All Formations



Bounding Overwatch: Line Formation





Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – ABCT EW PLT



U.S. ARMY

- ABCT EW PLTs are a mounted formation that has 4 vehicles
 - Advantages:
 - More mobility
 - More Equipment
 - More protection from small arms
 - Disadvantages
 - Significantly less stealth
 - Less accessibility to terrain
 - More maintenance/logistic requirements





Maneuvering the Mounted PLT



U.S. ARMY

- Common reasons to remain mounted:
 - Initial movement to an OP or staging area
 - Short reconnaissance mission
 - Running logistics to and from a forward site
 - Maneuvering with another maneuver or security element



**This is a big target
with only limited
protection and very
limited fire power**



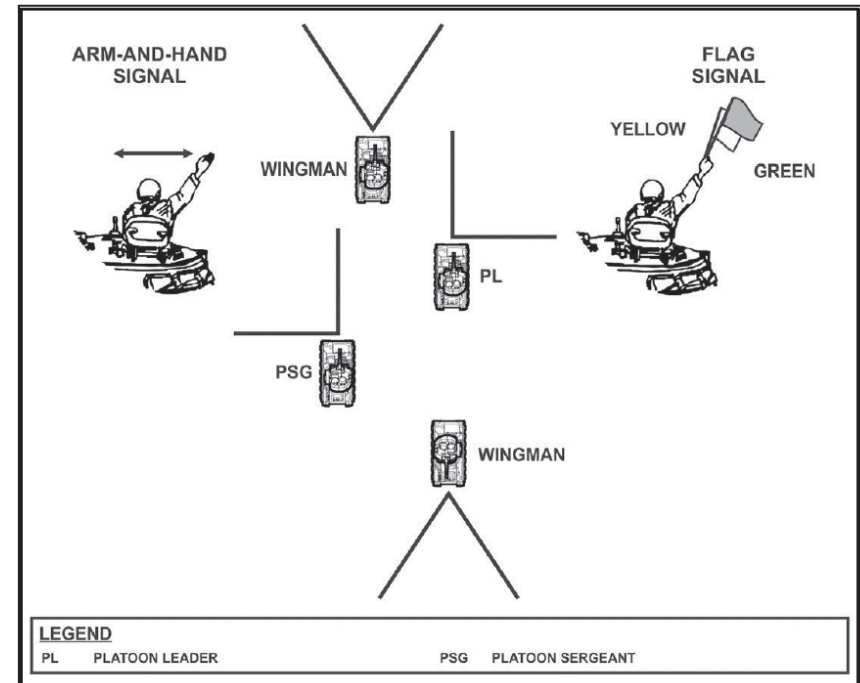
Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – Staggered Column



U.S. ARMY

- Staggered Column Formation: A modified column formation with one section leading, and one section trailing to provide overwatch.
- Permits good fire to the front and flanks.
- Used when speed is critical, when there is a limited area for lateral dispersion, or when enemy contact is possible.

Staggered Column





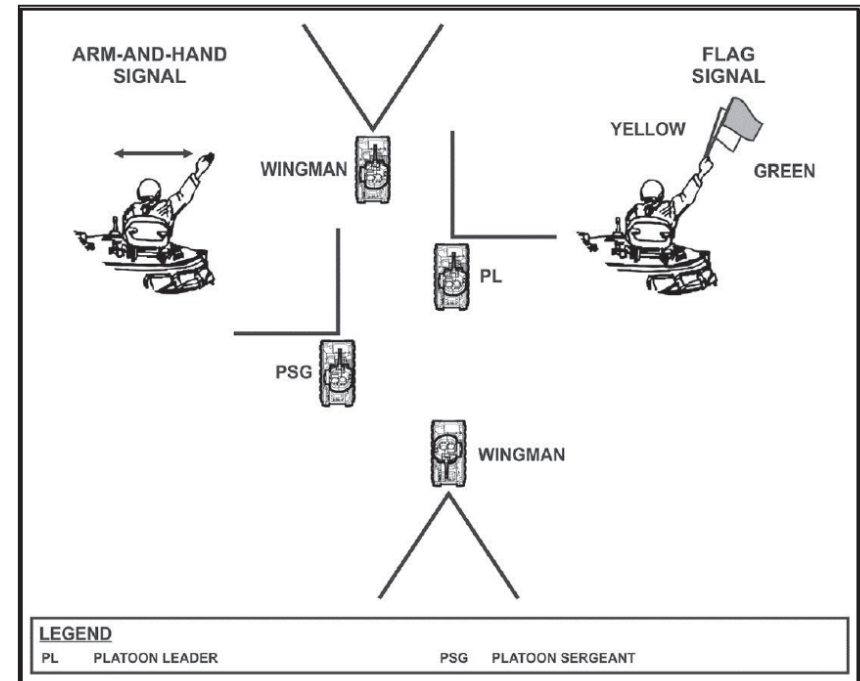
Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – Staggered Column



U.S. ARMY

- Reality:
 - Good formation for moving prior to contact.
 - Logistics and moving through friendly areas.
- EW Consideration:
 - Keep your antennas down to avoid being a target or running into things.

Staggered Column



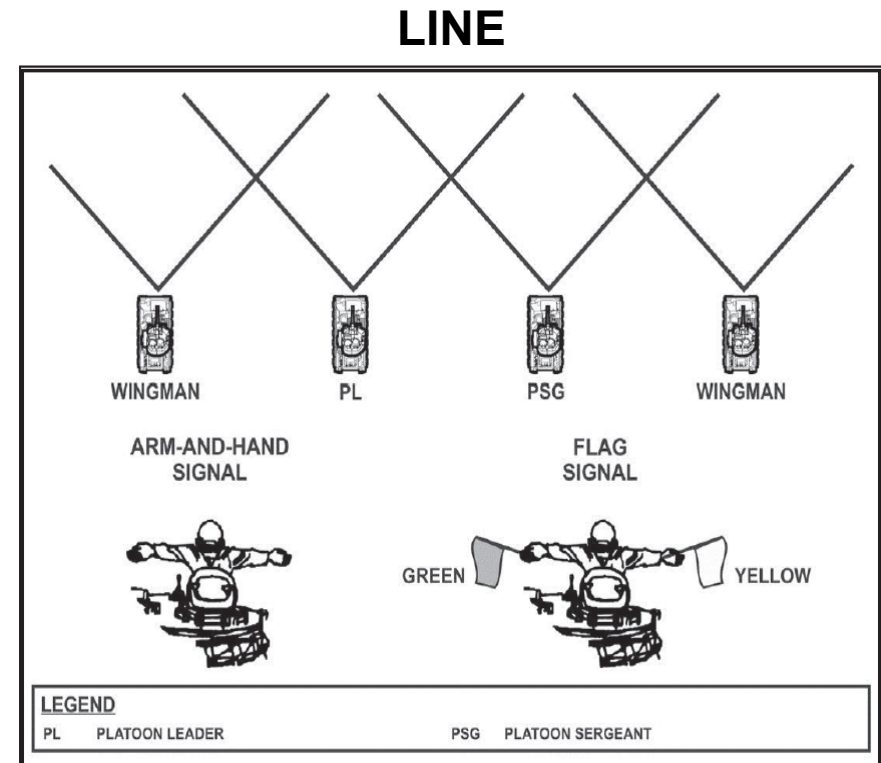


Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – Line



U.S. ARMY

- Line Formation: A movement formation in which elements move abreast of each other.
- Used for assaulting a weakly defended objective, crossing open areas, or occupying a support-by-fire position.
- Used when no terrain remains between it and the enemy.



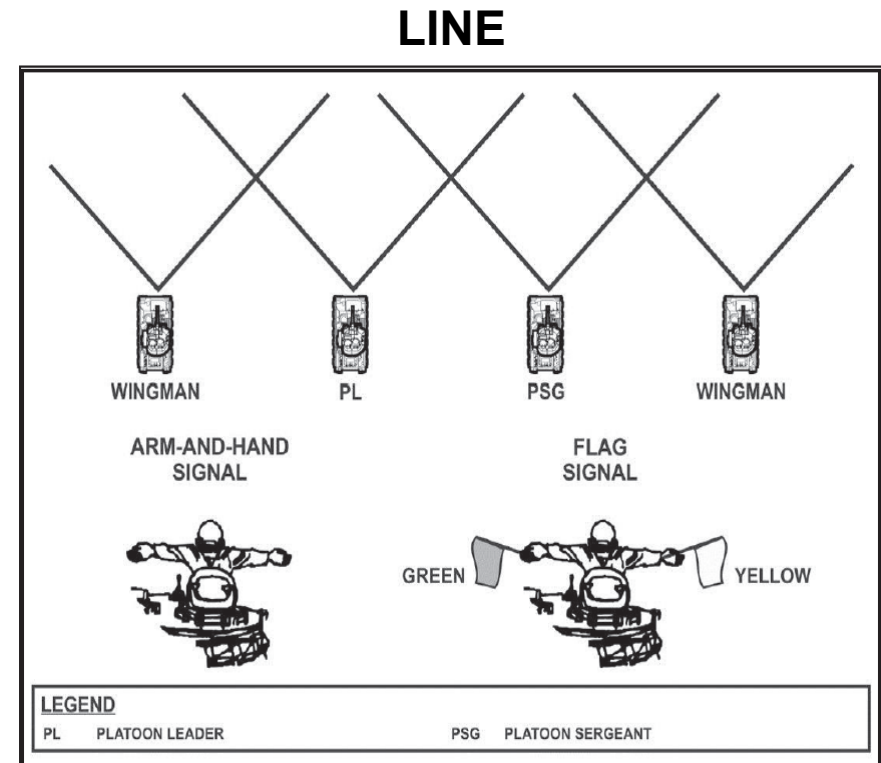


Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – Line



U.S. ARMY

- Reality:
 - Can be used to deliberately clear terrain before occupation.
- EW Consideration:
 - Not a great formation for the EW PLT, due to poor geometry if doing Direction Finding on the go.
 - EW PLT does not have much fire power to maximize.



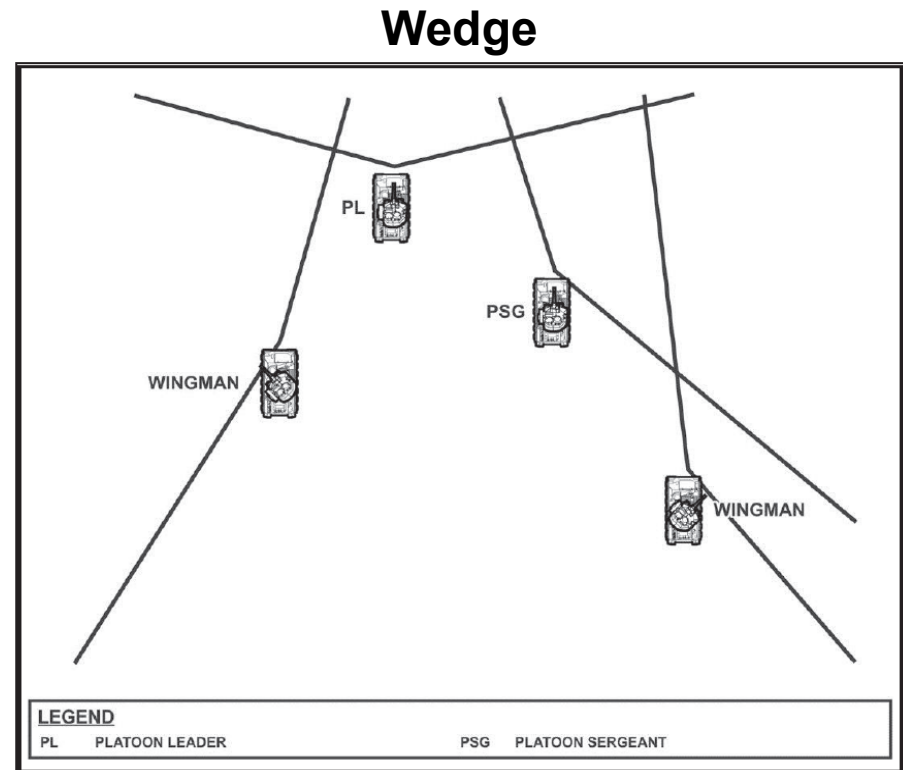


Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – Wedge



U.S. ARMY

- Wedge Formation: A movement formation with one lead element and the trail elements are paired off abreast of each other on the flanks.
- Permits excellent firepower to the front and good fire to each flank.
- Platoon leader can easily control all vehicles and deploy rapidly into other formations.
- Used when the enemy situation is vague.



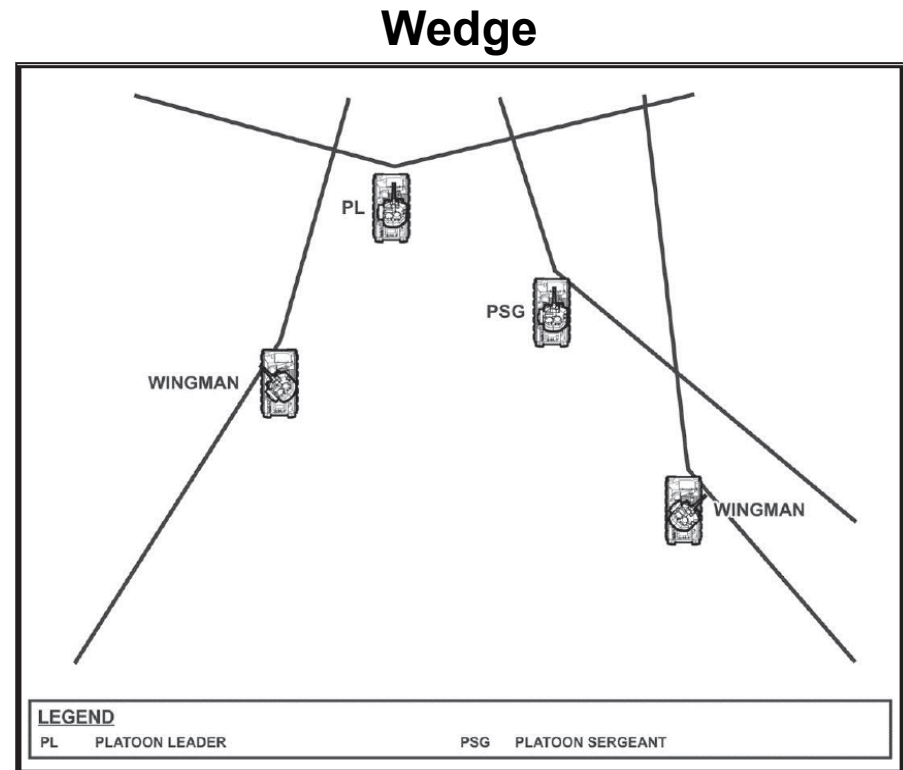


Maneuvering the Mounted PLT – Wedge



U.S. ARMY

- Reality:
 - Good formation to use when maneuvering in open terrain.
- EW Consideration:
 - Used once out of friendly controlled areas maneuvering in the open.



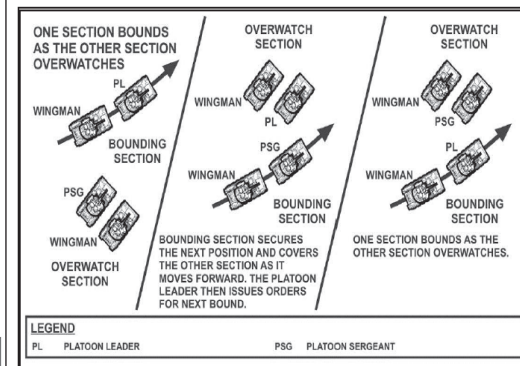
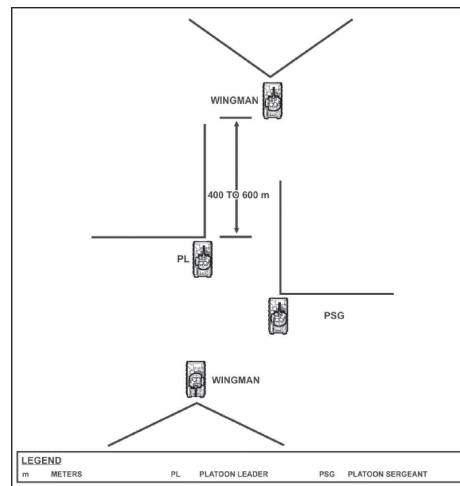
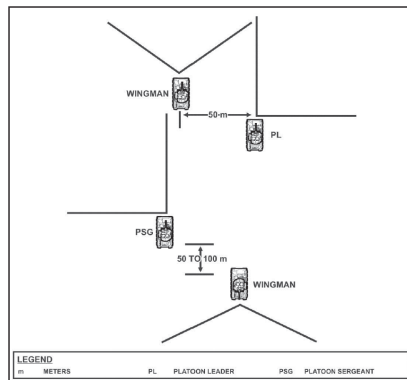


Maneuvering as a Mounted Team – Movement Techniques



U.S. ARMY

- Movement Techniques:
 - Traveling: Normal movement and spacing
 - Traveling Overwatch: Normal movement and increased spacing between lead and rear
 - Bounding Overwatch: Fast movement between halts. Halts to provide overwatch another element while it moves.





U.S. ARMY



Examine Actions on Contact



Actions on Contact

U.S. ARMY

- Four actions upon taking contact:
 1. React
 2. Develop the situation
 3. Choose an action
 4. Execute and report
- A way for leaders to:
 - Quickly determine if things are going according to plan.
 - What actions are needed to take to either stay on plan or adjust to the new situation.





React

U.S. ARMY

- Enemy initiates contact >>> Conduct react to contact battle drill
- Unengaged units monitor the situation and prepares to:
 - Support the unit in contact
 - Continue mission
- Unit in contact reports the contact to higher headquarters
 - Helps the higher HQ to develop the situation.
 - Alerts higher echelon
 - Allows initiation of necessary actions





Develop the Situation



U.S. ARMY

- Unit in contact develops the situation to define the threat being faced.
 - Helps to develop the situation across the front of the unit.
 - Provides more maneuver space to execute further actions.
- As the situation develops and the enemy force's dispositions, strength, and intentions become clearer.
 - Unit in contact submits additional reports.





Develop the Situation

U.S. ARMY

- Things to consider:
 - Size, activity, location, composition, and orientation of the enemy force
 - Impact of obstacles and terrain
 - Enemy capabilities
 - Probable enemy intentions
 - Method of gaining positional advantage over the enemy
 - Friendly situation
 - Possible friendly actions to achieve the specified end state



Choose an Action

U.S. ARMY

- After the unit makes contact, its leader gathers information to make an assessment based on their understanding of the enemy and friendly forces' composition and disposition and chooses an action consistent with the higher echelon commander's intent and within the unit's capabilities.
- Attack
- Bypass
- Defend
- Delay
- Withdrawal





Execute and Report



U.S. ARMY

- Unit in contact takes the appropriate actions with the action selected.
 - May require approval by their higher echelon.
- If it is appropriate to engage enemy forces, the unit in contact initiates direct and indirect fires to gain the initiative.
- If the action is to:
 - Attack: immediately attacks if it has sufficient, immediately available combat power to overwhelm the enemy force.
 - Defend, delay or withdraw: Does so while maintaining contact and continuing to gain as much information as possible about the enemy forces disposition and positions.



Execute and Report



U.S. ARMY

- Bypass: Maintains contact and continues their mission.
- Unit in contact will maintain contact no matter which action is chosen.
 - Unless told by their higher headquarters to break contact.
- Reporting to the next higher echelon is required to ensure the unit is staying within the commander's intent.





Summary



U.S. ARMY

- Examined Combat Power of the EW PLT by Mobility Type
- Discussed Key Considerations of Mobility Type
- Analyzed Formations and Techniques by Mobility Type
- Examined Actions on Contact



U.S. ARMY



Questions